



1099

THE ARMY OF THE FIRST CRUSADE TAKES JERUSALEM

A crusader army led by Raymond of Toulouse, Godfrey of Bouillon, and Bohemond of Taranto set out in 1096 in answer to a call to arms from Pope Urban. Their goal was to re-establish Christian control of the Holy Land. The army fought its way across Asia Minor and engaged in a lengthy siege at Antioch, before storming Jerusalem amid a massacre of its Muslim residents and local Christians.

◁ The capture of Jerusalem

1109

1098 The Cistercian Order is founded by former Benedictine monks

1100

GREAT ZIMBABWE BUILT

The city of Great Zimbabwe in southern Africa probably served as a royal capital, growing rich on the gold trade between the interior and the East African coast. Ringed by great dry-stone walls, it housed up to 20,000 people and remained the dominant centre in the region until about 1400.



△ Great Zimbabwe ruins



◁ Thule comb handle

c. 1100

THE THULE INUIT BEGIN A MIGRATION

The Thule began to move eastwards from their ancestral homelands in Alaska into the Canadian Arctic. With their advanced harpoons and seal-skin boats they could hunt bowhead whales and seals far out to sea, and they displaced the Dorset Eskimo people who had previously inhabited the eastern Arctic, reaching Greenland by about 1200.